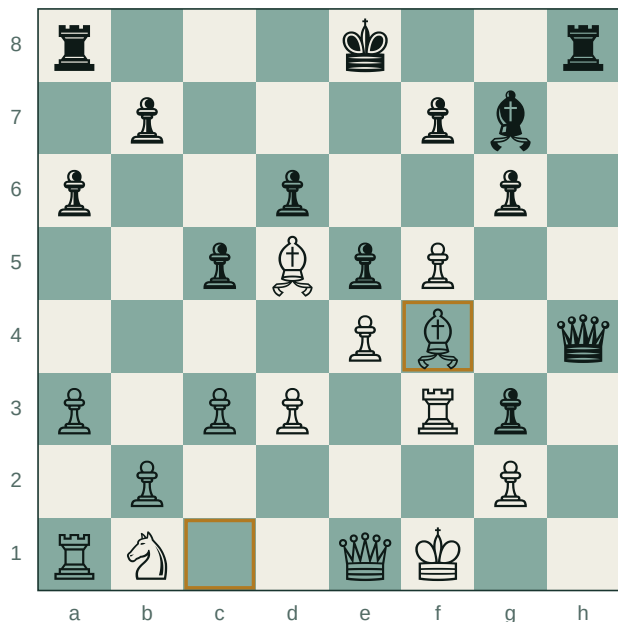


Deflection tactics: Black, move 23

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 23.Bxf4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

23...Qh1+ 24. Ke2 Qxg2+ 25. Rf2 gxf2

23...Qh1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **24.Ke2**.

24...Qxg2+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From g2 it attacks king on e2 and rook on f3. Recorded reply: **25.Rf2**.

25...gxf2 The pawn captures the rook on f2.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 30 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -5 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on f1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.